

OnePlus Nord Buds 2

A worthy upgrade for bass lovers

The OnePlus Nord Buds 2 brings a flurry of changes and new features including a design overhaul, Active Noise Cancellation up to 25 dB, improved battery life, and more. Priced at ₹2,999, we reckon that they'll sell like hotcakes, but I'm here to tell you if you ought to take the plunge. Let's find out!

BUILD, DESIGN, AND FIT

The OnePlus Nord Buds 2's case looks and feels infinitely more premium than its predecessor's. The earbuds, on the other hand, largely retain the design from its predecessor. The design is clunky-looking but the earbuds are exceptionally lightweight. Thanks to that, wearing these over extended periods comes with little to no discomfort or pain. The angled nozzles of the earphones also ensure that the fit is absolutely snug. Overall, these are extremely comfortable earbuds to wear, and due to the IP55 dust and water resistance, you can easily use the OnePlus Nord Buds 2 as your running or gym companion.

FEATURES

The OnePlus Nord Buds 2 add Active Noise Cancellation to the mix, that was missing on the OG OnePlus Nord Buds. The earbuds come with a couple of OnePlus-only features such as Dolby Atmos (for selected OnePlus phones), Dirac Audio Tuner (with the OnePlus Nord CE 3 Lite), and Fast Pairing through Oxygen OS. Almost all the features can be used by everyone with the HeyMelody app downloaded. OnePlus users can access the features provided by this app directly in their Settings menu. Let's talk about the app's features. We love that OnePlus has included a customisable EQ. The BassWave slider is something I didn't get much benefit from. The Game Mode toggle brings a subtle difference in audio/video delay when this mode is turned on for the better. The app also comes with

the option to customise touch controls; sadly, there are no volume controls. The app provides users with a fair number of nifty features. On-ear detection (auto pause and play) is usually found in earphones at this price point, so it's upsetting to see OnePlus skipping out.

PERFORMANCE

The sound signature of both the OG OnePlus Nord Buds and the Nord Buds 2 are almost indistinguishable. You've got a generic U-shaped sound signature which emphasises on the bass response the most. The mid-range is pretty well-produced, there's a spike in the 1 kHz to 2 kHz mark, which continues on to the highs. This helps in a way since the boomy bass does tend to overlap with the mids but the spike in the high mids ensures that vocals aren't suppressed to a great degree. The highs are sparkly and decently produced. However, they can sound a bit underwhelming at times due to auditory masking from the bloated bass response and the emphasised mids. So, bass lovers, rejoice! The ANC manages to subdue the constant drone of an air conditioner with ease but finds it difficult to silence sounds such as people talking and typing on a

mechanical keyboard. The Transparency Mode is decent as well, but nothing to write home about. The buds managed to stay connected to the source device (Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra) even with 2-3 walls between them and a whole floor of a building vertically, which is seriously impressive. The microphone quality is also pretty decent – my voice on a call sounded pristine and clear, but the person on the other end of the call could hear most of the background noise.

BATTERY LIFE

In our tests, the earphones lasted 4 hours and 32 minutes with ANC turned on, at about 50 per cent volume. With the case, you get another 4 charges with some juice left to spare. These numbers are quite impressive at this price range. Additionally,

the earbuds also come with fast charge support where a quick 10 minute charge gets you 5 hours of playback time (earbuds + charging case). There's no wireless charging support though.

VERDICT

The OnePlus Nord Buds 2 makes meaningful upgrades to its predecessor and is well worth its ₹3K price tag. The sound quality will speak volumes to bass lovers – the punchy and impactful bass response will have bass enthusiasts head-banging to tunes, however, purists and audiophiles may need to look away. If you're looking for slightly more balanced sound at around the same price, the Blaupunkt Moksha BTW07 is a slightly better option to consider.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Weight (Earbuds): 4.7g (±0.2g) | Weight (Charging case): 37.5g (±1g) | Colours: Lightning White, Thunder Grey | Driver: 12.4mm Titanium Driver | Battery life (ANC on): 5h/27h | Battery life (ANC off): 7h/36h | Fast charge: Yes | Bluetooth version: Bluetooth 5.3 | IP Rating: IP55 | Game Mode: 94ms

CONTACT

OnePlus | Phone: 1800 102 8411 | Email: onepluscare@oneplus.com | Website: <https://www.oneplus.in/>

